Property decision summary

5 Northam Street, Glen Waverley

Price guide: $1,550,000–$1,650,000 **Sale method:** Auction, Saturday 14 November 2026 at 11:00 am **Property:** 4 bed, 2 bath, 2 garage, 581 m² (the price statement says 677 m²), two-level family house (renovated, as the listing claims) **Parents' budget cap:** $1,500,000 purchase price (family decision, 27 Oct 2026; Checked) *Listing details are the agent's claims (listing 152636156, read 29 Oct 2026): Needs verification.*

Bottom line

- **Budget:** The guide starts $50,000 above the parents' $1.5m cap and tops out $150,000 above it. Glen Waverley's 4-bed house median is $1,603,000, down 5.7% in a year (realestate.com.au, 12 months to Sep 2026; Checked).
- **Market timing:** Evidence suggests Melbourne house prices will keep weakening into the first half of 2027, with a likely trough around mid-2027 (buying summary base case, following NAB's October forecast; Estimate).
- **Suburb fit:** 52.3% of Glen Waverley families are couples with children (Victoria 45.5%; ABS 2021, Checked), so expect family buyers at auction (Estimate), though the house is outside the Glen Waverley Secondary zone. The house suits a family; would a four-bedroom house with lawns and established gardens to maintain suit how the parents want to live for the next 10 years?
- **Location:** Its clear strength: the family is already in Glen Waverley.
- **Nature fit:** Jells Park is nearby (listing claim). Wheelers Hill shares it at a lower median, and Endeavour Hills, Frankston and Seaford offer different and sometimes more extensive nature access at lower prices. (Not a scored comparison: Glen Waverley has no workbook nature score.)
- **Community fit (secondary priority):** Glen Waverley is already in the workbook's High community band (ABS 2021: 8.0% India-born; Checked). Of the alternatives, only Clayton South has a higher India-born share (14.9%).
- **Recommendation:** Do not bid at or above the guide unless independent comparable sales justify it and the family deliberately raises the cap.

Why caution is warranted

The guide is above the cap before any auction competition. The buying summary's base case puts a $1.5m house at about $1.41m–$1.44m at the mid-2027 trough, a further fall of about 4–6% (Estimate). The same fall on a $1.6m purchase is about $64,000–$96,000 (Estimate), against $60,000–$90,000 on a $1.5m one. The summary does not rule out buying a suitable, well-priced house before the trough; this one is not yet shown to be well priced, and the agent's price statement (2 Oct 2026) lists no comparable sales.

Alternatives

Suburb	Workbook status	House price (basis)	Drive to GW	Main advantage
Glen Waverley	Active shortlist	$1,675,000 (sale median)	0 min	Family already here; multicultural convenience
Wheelers Hill	Community comparator	$1,475,000 (SOI median)	12 min†	Family proximity and Jells Park
Endeavour Hills	Community comparator	$857,000 (SOI median)	26 min†	Bushland and community access
Frankston	Active shortlist	$834,296 (sale median)	25 min	Beach, reserves and train access
Seaford	Watchlist	$861,235 (AVM, not a sale median)	24 min	Coastal and wetland lifestyle
Springvale	Community comparator	$942,500 (SOI median)	26 min†	Strong Indian-community infrastructure
Keysborough	Community comparator	$975,000 (SOI median)	24 min†	Family and community access

Workbook figures, Checked (Glen Waverley: realestate.com.au, 12 months, 442 sales). Suburb medians are not like-for-like with one renovated house; they show where the budget goes further. Drive times: Google Maps, typical traffic, not peak; "leave now", 26 Oct 2026, except †top of the 10:00 weekday range, 28 Oct 2026.

Decision test: proceed only if all are true

1. Independent settled comparable sales support a written walk-away price.
2. The family deliberately approves raising the $1.5m cap.
3. The house is genuinely better than realistic alternatives on the shortlist.
4. A building and pest inspection shows the renovation is more than cosmetic.
5. Met: Mount View Primary and Brentwood Secondary zones, not Glen Waverley Secondary's (Find My School 2027).
6. Title, planning overlays, easements, the vendor statement and land size (581 or 677 m²) raise no material issues.
7. The parents are comfortable holding the property for at least 7–10 years.

Recommended position

Do not bid simply because the house is appealing. Treat it as a high-discipline exception, not a default purchase. Set a hard walk-away price before auction day from recent settled comparable sales. If the house does not clearly beat realistic alternatives on price, nature access and long-term fit, keep searching: Wheelers Hill, Endeavour Hills, Frankston, Seaford and Springvale.

Decision framework, not a valuation or financial advice. Workbook 5704d65; buying summary d46e819. Approved 29 Oct 2026.